

choice based on regions from the list above

1. Create follow up actions google doc leveraging the following template here.

1. Schedule the follow up call for actions with the leader, DIB team member Candace or Liam and the Business Partner for the group.

1. Create a confidential slack channel if needed for that Reverse AMA to communicate transparently action items and or ongoing feedback, etc.

Reverse Ask Me Anything

The Reverse AMA format was launched in Sales with our Black team members. We wanted to start with this with Black team members to show support and to stand in solidarity, in response to domestic events in the US, and globally. One of our core values is DIB (Diversity, Inclusion and Belonging), and part of embracing that value means being better allies. These can be scheduled to facilitate meaningful conversations with any underrepresented group.

Benefits

- Improve efforts at driving inclusion and belonging at every level
- Enhance open communication
- Direct access to the leadership
- Opportunity to share experiences and provide feedback
- Improve Talent Acquisition, Retention and Mobility of underrepresented groups
- Continue to grow our great network of diverse talent

Goals

- To continue the momentum of conveying genuine empathy and solidarity for our underrepresented team members
- To address areas of challenges and opportunities identified by underrepresented team members
- To allow for open, honest communication within a specific format
- To increase interaction between Sales Leadership and team members
- To identify opportunities to implement specific DI&B initiatives with leadership support

Format

- A 50 minute closed Zoom call
- Attendees: E-Group member and interested team members in the relevant department who identify as part of the underrepresented group
- Questions asked by the E-Group member, answered by underrepresented group team members
- Format facilitated by People Business Partners

Schedule

- Quarterly

Actions and follow ups

All actions and follow up items should live in the Reverse AMA EPIC under the child EPIC for the Reverse AMA

If your underrepresented group has not been assigned a Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging team directly responsible individual please contact Candace or Liam.

SECTION: communication/chat.md

Introduction

At GitLab, Slack is critical to our communication with each other. While it enables real-time communication, we also are careful to remain true to our asynchronous mindset, suggesting that GitLab team-members set "do not disturb" and not expect real-time answers from others all the time.

There are groups of channels that can help with various areas of GitLab. This page speaks to a few subsets of those channel groups.

Search

Search for channels using either the Search GitLab toolbar, using a channel name with the channel-name format, or go the left sidebar, click on More and then Channel browser.

Channels

Key Slack channels

The alphabetically sorted starter list below spotlights a few of GitLab's many Slack channels in an effort to provide guidance to team members regarding the best places to ask specific questions and/or engage in discussion on a variety of topics. See Slack's Help Center for instructions on browsing all available channels.

Channel	Purpose
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-----	-----
company-fyi	Official company announcements, restricted permission levels to ensure high-signal; all GitLab team members are automatically added to this channel.
whats-happening-at-gitlab	Open to all team members for unofficial updates which are important and/or useful to most or all of GitLab, including reminders, events, project updates, etc.; all GitLab team members are automatically added to this channel.
diversityinclusionandbelonging	Stay up to date on GitLab's latest Diversity, Inclusion and Belonging initiatives and share feedback and thoughts about how we can make our environment even more inclusive.
expense-reporting-inquiries	For questions pertaining to expenses (e.g. Navan).
git-help	Specific questions about using Git in the terminal.
is-this-known	Get help in finding existing issues for existing

problems.

|

| ithelp | Create a Help Request in this channel should you have any IT general questions or trouble with setup (e.g. 2FA, accounts, etc.). |

| mr-buddies | For any questions regarding merge requests.

|

| newteammembers | For new GitLab team members to introduce themselves to the company and for existing team members to share updates with new hires.

|

| new-vacancies | For all GitLab team members to be aware of internal opportunities, as well as all job openings as they are listed. Please review the referral process page to find out more about referring someone for a role.

|

| payroll | For questions pertaining to payroll and contractor invoices (e.g. ADP, etc.).

|

| safe | SAFE

|

| security | Security

|

| talent-acquisition | For questions about referrals, the hiring process, and/or candidate status.

|

| team-member-updates | To stay updated on transitions/promotions, new GitLab team members joining, work anniversaries, etc.

|

General Channels {random-room}

There are a lot of general channels, just to name a few:

- questions: Ask all of GitLab for help with any question you have... and then go document it after you find the answer :)
- thanks: Where GitLab team-members can say thanks to those GitLab team-members who did a great job, helped a customer, or helped you! Also where managers recognize discretionary bonuses for their teams.
- office-today: GitLab is an all-remote organization. Where's your office today?
- remote: To share news, thoughts, feedback and anything else pertaining to remote work! Learn more about GitLab's approach to remote work
- travel: A place to discuss all things travel
- women: Employee resource group for members and allies.
- values: Channel to discuss iterations on GitLab values
- random: Socialize and share random snippets with your fellow GitLab team-members.

Getting in touch with the e-group

To get in touch with the e-group on Slack, you can use the following channels. When in doubt, you can use the general e-group channel to reach out to the entire group.

| Member | Channel |

----- -----
CEO ceo
CFO finance
CProdO product
CTO cto
CRO cro
CMO cmo
CPO cpo
CLO legal
CISO ciso

Team Channels

To raise an issue with a specific team, please use below most commonly used channels;

- ithelp: For IT related queries, Okta, issues with hardware, software, system access requests and user permissions etc
- talent-acquisition: For referrals based questions, candidate alignments, general talent acquisition etc

Channel Categories

Account Channels (a)

These channels (prefixed with a a) are for team members to collaborate and communicate regarding the account for a customer organization. Depending on the customer, they are sometimes internal, marked as private or we shared with the customer by connecting to customer's own Slack workspace. In order to clearly differentiate between these shared and internal channels, we recommend using aXYZ-internal and aXYZ-external naming conventions to be explicitly clear (as the shared symbol can be easily missed in Slack).

To request a new channel or to make changes to existing channels, please use the Slack Request form.

Commercial (Mid-Market and SMB) accounts have specific guidelines around having Slack channels with customers.

External Channels (ext-)

These channels (prefixed with ext-) are used for communication with vendors or partners. They are typically shared channels between GitLab's Slack workspace and the external organization's Slack workspace.

Example

- ext-gitlab-abc: Shared channel with Customer/Vendor ABC for project collaboration and support.

When using an external channel, ensure that you follow GitLab's guidelines for external communication, including keeping information SAFE. External channels with no activity in the

last year will be removed by CorpSec.

Steps:

1. Create an access request with template "slackgooglegroup1Passwordgroupvault".
1. After the access request is approved by your manager, please invite the external party to our Slack workspace. This will generate a message in shared-channels.
1. Please share that access request by replying to the message generated in shared-channels. An administrator will then approve the request.

Feature Channels (f)

These channels are for teams and GitLab team-members interested in a specific feature that exists in GitLab or is being built today!

Examples

- fwebide: Share ideas and feedback about our Web IDE
- fldap: Talk about our integration with LDAP providers.

Group Channels (g)

Group channels (prefixed with a g) correspond to a DevOps Stage group and other engineering departments and teams.

Example

- gcreate: Channel for the Create development group.
- gcreatesource-code: Channel for the Source Code development group.
- ggeo: Dedicated to the Geo group.

Location Channels (loc)

These channels are used to help GitLab team-members who are in the same general region of the world to talk about get-togethers and other location-specific items. They are also instrumental if you're going to be visiting somewhere else in the world - there might be a GitLab team-member or two nearby! Feel free to join the channel temporarily to chat with GitLab team-members who live there, and see if there is an opportunity to leverage the visiting grant to add value to your trip.

If there's a channel not listed below, please add in alphabetical order with an MR.

| Channel Name | Description |

|---|---|

| loc4corners | people that live in Utah, Colorado, Arizona, and New Mexico for meet-ups |

| locadelaid | For the growing team presence in Adelaide, South Australia! |

| locafrica | |

| localberta | Locals to Alberta, Canada |

| locamsterdam | Amsterdam location-specific channel |

| locannapolis | |

locarizona	Discussion / Intro / Meetup for people in Arizona, USA
locavl	Asheville, North Carolina
locatl	House channel for greater Atlanta area
locatx	Austin, Texas!
locaustralia	Australia Specific Chat
locaustria	A channel around the beautiful city of Vienna, come and visit us!
locbali	Channel for those traveling to Bali in 2022.
locbayarea	House channel for Mountain View.
locbc	British Columbia, Canada
locbelgium	
locberlin	All things going on in Berlin, Germany. We are regularly meeting up on the 3rd Thursday of the Month.
locboston	For folks living in or around the Greater Boston metro area; monthly coworking in downtown Boston second Wednesday of each month.
locbrisbane	Discuss all the Brisbane things
loc-budapest	For those who love, live and work in Budapest
loccanada	All things Canada ..
loccenacoastca	Connecting those living or passing through the Central Coast of California
locchennai	
loc-chicagoland	To connect folks in the Chicagoland area of the U.S.
loccincy	
locclt	For those who live in/near (or visit) the Charlotte, NC, USA area!
loc-costa-rica	
locczech	.. living in or visiting Czech Republic?
locdallas	
locdelaware	delaWHERE?
locdelhinc	
locdenmark	
locdenver	All things Denver, CO and surrounding areas!
locdigital-nomad	Anyone else living the digital nomad life? Maybe let's find spots to travel together! Share your travel plans if you'd like and make connections abroad .
locdmv	for people in and around DC, Maryland, Virginia
locdontmesswithtexas	
loc-dublin	Connection with the Dublin team
locegypt	.. Masr Heya Ommy ..
lochamburg	Local channel for Hamburg, Germany
lochawaii	For people traveling to, or living in Hawaii
lochouston	
lochungary	For folks living in or visiting Hungary
lociceland	GitLab team members in Iceland
locindia	Indians at GitLab
locindianapolis	Local Indiana/Indianapolis GitLab team members
locireland	
locisrael	Sync Locally for GitLab team members in Israel
locitaly	
locjapan	
lockansas-city	Channel for KC GitLabbers
lockerala	Anything about Kerala
lockorea	
locky	Location: Kentucky - Georgetown, Lexington, and Versailles

| loc-latam | For all team members from Latam , rest of the world welcome as well |
| locleipzig | NY Times list of places to visit in 2020:
<https://www.nytimes.com/interactive/2020/travel/places-to-visit.html?place=leipzig> |
loclille	
loclondon-uk	London meetups!
locmanchester	Channel for GitLab team members from Manchester (UK) and it's surrounding areas
locmars	Being optimistic
locmelbourne	
locmexico	For people living/visiting Mexico · ·
locmichigan	All Things "Great Lakes State"
loc-midwest-u-s	To connect with GitLab team members in the Midwest region of the U.S.
locminnesota	
locmontreal	
locmoscow	
locmt	Montana GitLab Team Members
locmunich	· A lot of people from Germany live in and around Munich. Additionally, there is a bi-weekly calendar series for co-working sessions.
locn-ireland	N.Ireland slack channel, so it is
locnashville	Nashvillians Unite!
locnetherlands	For anyone living or visiting The Netherlands
locnewengland	Channel for those located in New England
locnewyork	
locnigeria	
locnocoakaloconoco	Connect GitLab team members who are in Boulder, Larimer and Weld Counties of Northern Colorado
locnrw	For all folks from North Rheine-Westphalia(NRW), Germany. ·
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ReIJAtyslyE>	
locnuremberg	Franconia, Germany - gingerbread, sausages, and more
locnyc	Coordinate NYC-area coworking days and other events. Let us know if you're coming to town, and see our visitors doc! · · ·
<<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1aTW4P0V44S9hBppStCOVI3bfLq6qW6hoJFWEr6HOdA/>>	
locnz	· · For those visiting, living in or interested in Aotearoa New Zealand. Also half of locaustralia is in here too.
<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1VijZowFu8WpyV17MtRtrvz1GUqw9Y5Bcf-OkUOEUEU774/edit>	
locohio	For GitLab team members in the Buckeye State
locottawa	
locpdx	For GitLab team members in/around Portland Oregon
locperth	Join us (me) for enthralling (adequate) Perth, Australia conversation
locphiladelphia	Philly local items/discussion/events
locphilippines	
locpittsburgh	A city of bridges, 3 rivers and fries on top of salads
locpnw	For GitLab team members living in or visiting the Pacific Northwest (Cascadia): Washington, Oregon, and BC (Canada), includes Seattle and Portland.
locpoland	For anyone living or visiting Poland · ·
locportugal	For anyone living or visiting Portugal · ·
locqld	Queeeeeeeenslander!
locquebec	All things Quebec · ·
locratingen	I guess it's just me
locrdu	For those who live or visit the Raleigh Durham area in North Carolina, U.S.A.

locromania	..
locrussia	
locsacramentoreno	Visiting Sacramento, Roseville, Folsom, Elk Grove, Rocklin, Reno or even Tahoe? For GitLab team members based in the area and anyone who is visiting
locsanantonio	Channel for San Antonio GitLab Team Members
locsask	Saskatchewan (Canada) folks.
locsc	For GitLab team members living in South Carolina.
locscotland	Aye
locserbia	
locsingapore	
locslovenia	
locsocial	...
locsouthafrica	Mzansi!
locsoutheastasia	Chat for people staying / visiting ASEAN
locspain	
locswitzerland	Everything Switzerland ..
locsydney	
loctaiwan	
loctn	Tennessee!
loctokyo	Location: Tokyo, Japan
loctoronto	This is a channel for the Toronto team members.
locturkey	This is a slack channel for Turkey
locuk	For folks living, visiting, or interested in the United Kingdom
locusmid-atlantic	US Mid-Atlantic states)
locusa	General channel for USA
loc-utah	
locvegas	Are you visiting Vegas soon for fun or a conference? Connect with Vegas locals here for coffee meet-ups or recommendations!
locvermont	For our sole Vermonter ..
locwales	 - Come to discuss dragons, Brains · and rain ·
locwarsaw	Connection to Warsaw team
loc-west-lafayette	West Lafayette, IN GitLab team members
locwny	Western New York GitLab team members
locyugoslavia	whatever you wish

Project Channels (proj)

These channels are temporary and used to focus communication around a specific project. As an ephemeral channel they are archived once a project is complete and can be found in Slack by searching for proj

Working Group Channels (wg)

These channels are temporary and used to focus communication around a specific working group. As an ephemeral channel they are archived once the working group's exit criteria is met and can be found in Slack by searching for wg

Stage Channels (s)

Stage channels (prefixed with s) correspond to stages within sub-departments.

Examples

- senablement: For the Enablement stage.
- screate: For the Create stage.

Social Groups

In addition to weekly company group calls that bring us together, GitLab has Social Slack Groups. Social Groups are Slack channels that bring team members together around common interests, hobbies, and lifestyles. Think tennis club, gaming, shell collectors, movie buffs, faith groups, football. You can see a list of Social Slack Groups and their tags below. Feel free to join any that resonate with you. This is a non-exhaustive list, but if you don't see a group you'd love to see on the list, reach out to our diversity, inclusion and belonging team and we'd love to explore your idea.

Examples:

- all-caps: Light-hearted conversation in ALL CAPS.
- bookclub: A place for bibliophiles to connect, share recommendations and discuss their latest reads.
- cats, dog, cute-animal-photos: Show us your cutest pics of your pets! We love all pets, but we made special channels for cats and dog(s).
- cheerleader: When you need or want to share encouragement and support!
- cooking: Share your favorite recipes, and brag about your homemade dishes.
- dadjokes: Self-explanatory really, give us your best dad jokes!
- emilys: For all the Emily/ie/ia/ees at GitLab.
- fitlab: Channel to discuss fitness and related topics.
- gaming: Discuss gaming (both tabletop and video). We also have a Discord linked in the topic.
- i-made-this: Did you make a thing? Or are you in the process of making a thing? Whatever it is, tell us about it and post a photo!
- office-today: Where's your office today? Share a photo or use words to describe it.
- lego: Build, inspire, play. Share your builds and invite your children.
- lgbtq: Space for LGBTQ people and allies in GitLab to chat and support each other.
- managers: Share ideas, thoughts, and issues on all things to do with being a manager at GitLab.
- mentalhealthaware: Mental health is super important and we realize that. This is a place to discuss concerns you might be having or find someone to talk to if you're feeling alone. We aim to be supportive and available for all who need it.
- music: Share your current playlist or any interesting music you come across.
- postcrossing: Send team members postcards from your home cities, towns and villages from around the world.

SECTION: communication/confidentiality-levels.md

Public by default

At GitLab, we are public by default, but some information is classified as internal or limited access. This page provides details on confidentiality levels.

Not public

We make things public by default because transparency is one of our values.

Some things can't be made public and are either internal to the company or have limited access even within the company.

If something isn't listed in the sections below please refer to Security's Data Classification Standard and Legal's SAFE Framework in the Handbook for additional guidance.

Internal

Some things are internal to GitLab team only. In instances where a topic should only be accessible to team members, but otherwise the content would be in the public handbook, then this information should instead be added to GitLab's Internal Handbook. Background on the internal handbook can be found in the public handbook. It is okay to refer to the public handbook or the internal and public handbooks in aggregate as "the handbook." The Internal Handbook should always be referred to as the "Internal Handbook."

The following items are internal:

1. Security and abuse vulnerabilities are not public since they would allow attackers to compromise GitLab installations. We do make them public after we remediated a vulnerability. Issues that discuss how to improve upon the security posture of an implementation that is working as intended can be made public, and are often labeled as feature proposals. Security and abuse implementations that detect malicious activities cannot be made public because doing so would undermine our operations.
1. Financial information, including revenue and costs for the company, is confidential because we are a public company and, as such, need to limit both the timing and content of financial information as investors will use and rely on it as they trade in GitLab stock. Anything that is a first step to constructing a profit should be kept confidential. Examples include:
 - The specific IACV of an opportunity
 - Total monthly cash inflow/outflow for GitLab.com
 - Spend of more than 10%
 - A department's cost
 - Team member retention (analysts may make business assumptions based on this)
 - The Sales pipeline
 - Net and gross retention KPIs. Only the actual numbers can't be public. Other details, such as the goal and their calculation, may be public.
1. All external communications about any financial information should be in line with the company's SAFE Guidelines and Social Media Policy. If you have any questions please reach out via the Safe Slack channel.
1. Deals with external parties like contracts and approving and paying invoices.
1. Content that would compromise a GitLab team member, customer, or user's personal data, as defined in our Privacy Terms. Examples of compromising content include personal (not GitLab assigned) contact information, location data, online identifiers, employment information, government IDs, financial information, or sensitive data elements related to health, religion, race/ethnicity, political status, or sexual orientation.
1. Legal discussions are not public due to the purpose of Attorney-Client Privilege.
1. Competitive sales and marketing campaign planning is confidential since we want to minimize the time the competition has to respond to it.

1. Discussions that involve decisions related to country of residence are not public due to privacy and employment considerations. The output of such decisions, such as country hiring guidelines, will be public.
1. If public information compromises the physical safety of one or more team members, it will be made not public because creating a safe, inclusive environment for team members is important to how we work. Information that might compromise the physical safety of a team member includes doxxing or threats made against a team member.
1. Information related to a press embargo, or related to an upcoming publication where the response will be managed by our external communications team.
1. Information that relies on someone else's copyrighted IP. Our compensation calculator, for example, relies on private sources of information and can't be made completely public.
1. Information related to early exploratory initiatives in which premature sharing of information could slow down purchases.
1. When there is a product offering being developed that is expected to generate very high demand that cannot be quickly met, it should be kept internal in order to give the team the time to create the right solution.
1. Changes to GitLab.com free tier limits such as storage, data transfer, user limits or compute minutes are not public, as they are similar to Pricing and Packaging as discussed below in limited access.
1. Specific details about our hiring processes such as our scoring rubrics & criteria are not public as we want to ensure candidates provide an accurate overview of their experience and do not falsify their responses to meet our criteria. High-level interview plans are public and documented in each job family.
1. GitLab's strategy is internal-only. GitLab goal setting is intentionally ambitious. External folks, without context, could make misinterpretations about the company's financial health and strategic plans, so sharing this information may have unintended and undesirable effects.
1. Discussion, designs, and code that are subject to the Discovery phase of a patent application. Prior to filing the application all product and prototype development should take place outside of public repositories.

Limited access

The items below are not shared with all team members. Limited access is a more severe restriction than internal.

1. Deals with external parties like contracts and approving and paying invoices.
1. Content that would violate confidentiality for a GitLab team-member, customer, or user.
1. Customer information is generally not public due to confidentiality obligations and the problematic use of such information by our competitors. If an issue needs to contain any specific information about a customer, including but not limited to company name, employee names, or number of users, then the issue should be made confidential. When we discuss a customer by name or describe a customer in terms that could make them identifiable, this should only occur in private projects or by linking to the SFDC account in an internal GitLab issue.
1. Plans for reorganizations. Reorganizations may cause disruption and reorganization plans tend to change a lot before being finalized. We will keep relevant team members informed whenever possible.
1. Planned pricing changes. Much like reorganizations, plans around pricing changes are subject to modifications before being finalized. Thus, pricing changes are limited access while in development. Applicable team members will be consulted before any pricing changes are rolled out.

1. Certain discussions that relate to company policy or process changes. Some organizational policies are sensitive in nature and require thoughtful consideration before any communications are made. Relevant team members and leaders will be informed whenever possible.

1. Legal discussions are restricted to the purpose of Attorney-Client Privilege and some may be limited access instead of internal.

1. Some information is kept confidential by the People Group to protect the privacy, safety, and security of team members and applicants, including: job applications, background check reports, reference checks, compensation, terminations details, demographic information (age and date of birth, family or marital status, national identification such as passport details or tax ID, required accommodations), and home address. Whistleblower identity is likewise confidential. Performance improvement plans, disciplinary actions, and individual feedback are restricted, as they may contain negative feedback and negative feedback is 1-1 between you and your manager. However, People Group policies and processes are public (for example, Job families and our Compensation Calculator), along with limited information that team members choose to share on the Team page.

1. Acquisition offers by or of GitLab.

1. Compensation Changes: GitLab will communicate and train team members on the output of iterations to the Total Rewards offerings (Compensation, Equity, Benefits), but team members will not have visibility into the inputs and decision making of compensation changes.

1. Security Incident Investigation: In order to avoid exposing team members to MNPI, the Security Incident Response Team (SIRT) will restrict access to only those necessary to assess the materiality of incidents. Once an incident is determined to not have MNPI the access may be changed to internal.

Project names

Some projects require limited access internally due to the confidential or sensitive nature of the project, including but not limited to projects related to the items listed above. Often, in order to maintain the necessary confidentiality of these types of initiatives, we assign a code name for the project. For consistency and to make it easier to identify the genesis of these projects and their organizational affiliations, we've established the following naming conventions.

Project code names can be overused. Code names should only be used for projects in which the leaking of a descriptive name (even without access to any related content) would be a problem. There are two cases where the project name should be used instead of a name that clearly describes the project.

1. The existence of the project is material non-public information (MNPI). Example: "Gotham" was our project name for our IPO, because GitLab would have been penalized for pre-maturely signaling the imminence of its IPO.

1. Knowledge of the project or initiative is not MNPI but should remain limited access to avoid prematurely sharing information with team members, customers or the wider community. Examples include: "Tiering" was our project name for End of Availability, and "Hamster" was our project name for exploring how to enter China.

In many cases, key project or initiative content will be MNPI or limited access, but we do not use a code name. In these cases, it is okay for folks to have a sense of what is being worked on, but the exact details are sensitive. For example:

1. Q3 Earnings: material is MNPI until formally shared, but team members working on this is known and expected, not sensitive information.

1. Pricing and Packaging: as an example only, it would be okay to say that we had a group considering changes to P&P even if exact plans were kept limited access.

Once there is no longer a need to limit access of the project's existence for limited access or MNPI reasons, the code name for the project should be retired. Please note that a project does not need to be promoted (e.g., publishing a blog post) in order to be deemed publicly disclosed (i.e., not confidential); publishing the information in GitLab's external Handbook will suffice. If there are any questions about whether a project still requires the use of the code name, please contact the DRI for such project or contact the Legal Team via the safe Slack channel.

Team	Theme	
-----	-----	
CEO	Pets / Animals	
Corporate Development	Movie / TV Show characters	
Engineering	Hex color names	
Finance	Sports team names	
Legal	TV Shows / Movies	
Marketing	One name famous people	
People	Trees	
Product	Broadway Musicals	
Sales	Car model names	
Security	Mythology	

SECTION: communication/deep-dives.md

Deep Dive Sessions

The goal of a Deep Dive session is to share knowledge about a particular topic, with the assumption that recipients already have some basic understanding or aptitude for the given subject.

This aligns with how we work since everything at GitLab is public by default.

This is a particularly useful initiative within Engineering teams to mitigate dependencies between specific engineers and areas of the codebase, while also improving collaboration and product knowledge with the wider group.

An example format guideline:

- Introduction (why does this feature exist?)
- Demo (what problem does it solve?)
- Implementation Overview (how is it implemented?)
- Q&A

Note: The support team have documented similar initiatives in the handbook: Support Deep Dives and Support Training Modules.

Preparation steps

If you're new to presenting at GitLab the steps can be a bit daunting. The steps are mostly documented elsewhere in the handbook, but are summarized here to give an overview.

Schedule the call

1. Ensure you have a Pro zoom account by checking the web interface. This is needed so the call length isn't limited and to cloud record.

1. Duplicate the presentation template and get a sharing URL to add to the calendar. This will avoid spamming attendees by editing the description later. You can make it private or include a WIP slide until nearer the talk.

1. Use the Zoom App to schedule the call.

1. Set a title as this will be used for the recording.

1. Set it to record automatically.

1. Have it create a Google Calendar event as this will include the Zoom URL.

At a minimum it usually makes sense to invite your team to the session, but you may also want to invite other teams if you feel the topic is particularly relevant to them (e.g. you may want to invite the Security team if you're discussing authentication).

Publicise the Deep Dive

1. Mention it in your team's slack channel - including date, time, presentation link and zoom URL.

1. Invite anyone who'll be particularly interested in that topic to the calendar event.

1. Announce it on the company call.

1. Just before the call you might want to remind people in whats-happening-at-gitlab on slack including the zoom/presentation links.

After the call

1. The recording will be available through the Zoom web interface after processing.

1. Upload it to Google Drive.

1. Upload it to YouTube:

- Follow the instructions to get access.
- Add it to your team's playlist (if available).
- You can copy the description from a previous talk.
- You can screenshot the first slide and use that as the video thumbnail.

1. Create a .pdf of the talk to avoid the GitLab community needing Google Drive permissions for access.

1. Link to the talk from relevant development docs so the community can discover it.

Preparation tips

- A dry run really helps. Doing this through zoom means you can record it and play it back, as well as share the live zoom link to get more feedback.

- For a long talk stamina becomes more important; find ways to keep your energy up! Try to add cues to remind yourself of this as well and add breaks.

- The primary audience will be slightly familiar with the topic but other attendees will be

more interested in the high level overview.

- If available, you could use a second screen with a smaller resolution for the presentation & demo, so that any text would be bigger on the video.
- Increase the font size in your text editor and terminal.

SECTION: communication/power-of-the-pause.md

Power of the Pause

There are times in everyone's life when you can feel overwhelmed, anxious, angry or irritated about a situation. At the next small disturbance it pushes you to react in perhaps a moment of frustration. Everyone does it in their personal life as well as their work life. As a manager this can be particularly challenging and sometimes you react or say something in a meeting, via slack, an issue or email during the heat of the moment. In this section we are going to review the Power of the Pause and provide you with a few tips to help you take a moment and breathe before you respond.

What does it mean to P.A.U.S.E?

P - Practice Patience

Patience does not come naturally for most people. We live in a fast paced world of iterations. However, waiting a few moments to react and remaining patient through an encounter or issue can prevent some possible unfortunate actions or communications.

A - Adjust your Attitude

A shift in perspective or change in attitude makes a world of difference in how you approach different situations. Be willing to be open and even to extend an olive branch now and again. You can not always control what happens or how others respond to a situation but you can control your response.

U - Understand the Situation

Before you insert yourself in a situation make time to learn all the facts. Our reactions can sometimes be to jump on any perceived wrong. However, take time to review the facts, sift out opinions and assumptions to uncover the truth. Doing so can potentially stop you from stepping into a situation and creating a larger problem.

S - Step Outside

Take a moment and step away from the situation. If you can even take a moment to go outside and change your scenery. If you can't step outside try to remove yourself from the situation. A physical step back can often provide mental clarity and let's emotions subside.

E - Explain Calmly

Unfortunately when there is conflict, rational thought can succumb to negative emotions, making

it hard to form an appropriate response. Take time to pause and calm down while using one of the techniques above. When you have had a chance to adjust your attitude, understand the facts and have taken a moment to breathe you can move forward in a calm and rational manner.

Here are a few articles for additional reading:

- The Pause Principle
- The Power of Pause, Discover how to up your game and perform your best
- The Power of pause in leadership
- The Power of Pause

SECTION: communication/top-misused-terms.md

<!-- NOTE: To update misused terms, please open "data/misusedterms.yml -->

List of Top Misused Terms

Below are terms people frequently use when they should use another term.

{{< misused-terms >}}

<!-- leave this section at the bottom of the page -->

Slack

Slackbot (via configuration) can remind team members when they use a misused term.

SECTION: communication/video-playbook.md

GitLab Video Playbook

The purpose of this playbook is to help those who are looking to create video content determine what type of video they should create, how to get it done, and most importantly identify why the video should be created in the first place.

Everything needs a purpose, including your video

The first thing you should ask yourself when considering a video project is, "why am I doing this video?" In asking yourself that question, figure out what your purpose is for the video and why you feel there is a need for it. Also, be sure to check that a video hasn't already been created that fulfills the content gap you are seeking to fill.

Potential challenges

Remember, you don't need to create a perfect, award-winning film short. Do not let the pressure

of perfection stall your video project from coming to fruition.

In that same vein, do not get bogged down by your equipment, or lack thereof. If you have a camera on your laptop, you have enough equipment to create your video!

Types of videos you can contribute

When you think about creating content for GitLab, think short and sweet. Majority of the content created for our channels should be micro videos, which are short snippets of content that can be used to grab viewer interest and get your message across as quickly and succinctly as possible. Even content that seems like it should be lengthier, for instance a how-to video, can and should be created as a series of short, digestible micro videos.

If you have a lengthy video, perhaps from a meeting recording, please strongly consider cutting it down to a series of micro videos that cover specific topics or talking points.

Here are some common types of video content that you can contribute

Community content: These videos are created for the greater GitLab community and can include content for meetups, user stories, community-related actions at events, etc.

Kickoffs: These videos will cover the monthly release kickoffs as well as kickoffs for any other project that we'd like to publicly share.

Team meetings and office hours: This is pretty self explanatory. :)

Informal customer testimonials: These are videos of customer presentations or conversations at events or webcasts.

Instructional videos: These videos are meant to educate the viewer to the point where they walk away with some actionable knowledge. Instructional videos go by a variety of different names. But whether you need to make a how-to video or a tutorial, the goal is the same. Unlike other forms of video, an instructional video instructs. Of course, while you don't want boring videos, the main goal is for viewers to comprehend and learn what you are teaching them.

Don't share sensitive data

GitLab makes things transparent by default, but there are certain things that we intentionally keep private.

Please make sure you don't share any of these private items in any public video.

GitLab YouTube channels

We currently have two GitLab YouTube channels: Branded and Unfiltered.

What to post on each channel

The Branded channel features marketing and event content, customer, community and user stories, employment branding, and polished sales videos and demos. Please open an issue for an issue for

any video that is to be posted on the Branded channel.

The Unfiltered channel features content intended for team and community members, including (but not limited to) team meetings, discussions, monthly release kick-offs, office hours, CEO 101 meetings, and casual demos.

Posting to the branded YouTube channel

If you would like a video posted on the branded YouTube channel, please open a video-upload-request-youtube issue in the digital production project in growth marketing. Please only use this issue template for videos that do not require any additional editing. Before opening this issue, please make sure you already have written permission to post the video on our channel from all parties involved, including those on camera as well as those who filmed and produced the video.

For videos that require editing using already existing footage, please open an issue using the video-editing-request template in the corporate marketing project. Before opening this issue, please make sure you already have written permission to post the video on our channel from all parties involved, including those on camera as well as those who filmed and produced the video.

For videos that require filming, please use the video-request-new template in the digital production project in growth marketing.

Posting videos that were filmed externally

If you would like to post a video on our Branded or Unfiltered channel that was filmed by a partner, service or other provider, please open a video-upload-request-youtube issue in the digital production project in growth marketing. Please only use this issue template for videos that do not require any additional editing and be sure to have written permission to post the video on our channel from all parties involved, including those on camera as well as those who filmed and produced the video.

For videos that require editing using already existing footage, please open an issue using the video-editing template in the digital production project in growth marketing. Before opening this issue, please make sure you already have written permission to post the video on our channel from all parties involved, including those on camera as well as those who filmed and produced the video.

Connecting A YouTube Playlist to Slack

If you record meetings for your group you can automatically have the recordings posted in a Slack channel when they are added to a specific YouTube playlist. You can do this using the Zapier integration in Slack. Search for the Zapier app in Slack, and on the App's Home menu select - Make a New Zap. When setting up the connection between YouTube and Slack one of the most difficult tasks is finding your playlist to retrieve the necessary ID. It's best to find all GitLab Unfiltered Playlists by selecting Manage Videos on the Unfiltered Channel page. You can see some examples of this setup in the ops-section slack channels.

Optimize the impact of your video

- Talk about your topic like your target audience talks about it. The best way to reach people with video is to use the same words and phrases they do. If our internal labels differ from what our audience use, we should use their words as much as possible.
- Use your highest priority keyword or phrase in the title of your video. SEO on YouTube is similar to about.gitlab.com. Add supporting keywords in your description and provide additional context for visitors. You can find really valuable keyword data in Analytics > Reach > Traffic source: YouTube search. This will tell you the terms people used to find your videos, and help surface keywords you can optimize for future videos.
- Link back to pages on about.gitlab.com where appropriate and include a CTA to a relevant resource.
- Add your keyword targets as tags on your videos.
- Add a custom thumbnail. Experiment to find the best image setup for your audience. Many videos add the title to the custom thumbnail and add some other visual element from the video. YouTube uses a 1280 x 720 dimension image for videos.
- Clean up auto-generated captions Machine-generated captions often misspell or mangle technical terms, and the words in your video's captions can help influence SEO. Captions also broaden the audience for a video. Instructions for editing captions are available.

Need help with your video?

FAQs

Q: How long does it take to get a video up on one of our YouTube channels?

A: Please check the video template that you use to open an issue in order to find out how long it will take for your video to be uploaded to YT.

If you'd like to connect with someone on the Digital Production team for more help, please open an issue using one of the aforementioned templates and ping us in the youtube Slack channel.

Additional resources

- The virtual events page and best practices guide provide useful information if you intend to create videos from or for live events.

SECTION: communication/zoom/_index.md

Zoom-specific communication guides

GitLab uses Zoom as the primary video collaboration platform for internal and external communications. Some of our customers and partners have different preferred tools and to facilitate the communication with those parties, GitLab provides licenses for WebEx and MS Teams. This service is only provided to team members that have a business need to host meetings and where Zoom is not accepted. It is not efficient for GitLab to use multiple video conferencing tools, however we encourage the use of the most popular ones among our customers and partners when needed. E.g.; Zoom, WebEx, MS Teams, Skype, etc.

To request access to those tools, create an access request and provide a justification for

access.

Usage guidelines

Please visit the Tools and Tips handbook for Zoom usage guidelines.

Using Zoom for personal connection

COVID-19 is impacting how team members connect and communicate with family.

Due to school closures, parents are tasked with being responsible for their children while at home. Family and friends first, work second is an important Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging operating principle. To that end, we are encouraging GitLab team members to allow their children to connect with other children around the world.

During this time of physical distancing, GitLab team members are welcome to use Zoom to connect with family if other options like FaceTime, etc. are not an option. Please ensure that attendees who are not GitLab team members have their own Zoom account. To ensure GitLab does not incur toll charges, please use Internet-based voice when possible.

Zoom webinars

Please visit a detailed guide covering everything you need to know about hosting or participating in a GitLab webinar.

Return to the main Communication page.

SECTION: communication/zoom/webinars.md

Everything you need to know about hosting or participating in a GitLab webinar

Webinar roles

It's important to assign specific roles: host, active panelists and people answering written questions. Different roles will need different preparation and actions required during the Zoom webinar.

Host

This is the person that leads the webinar. This person will probably use a Google Doc to go through questions with the panelists.

If you're a host or alternative host, you'll notice in your calendar invite a Zoom link containing an /s/ before a string of numbers. This stands for start. (e.g. <https://gitlab.zoom.us/j/11111111>) If several people are designated as alternative hosts, the first person to join the webinar will claim host privileges. Once started, the webinar is

immediately live for participants.

If a host needs someone else to be able to start the meeting, they can assign an alternative host.

For more on Enabling and adding a co-host, please visit [Zoom's support page](#).

Active Panelists

These are the people interacting with the host. They should be in the same Google Doc as the host. If there are multiple active panelists, it's recommended that the panelists add their name and potential answer to the questions they would like to answer. This way, the host can direct the question to the right panelist.

For more on joining and participating in a webinar as an attendee, please visit [Zoom's support page](#).

Write-only Panelists

With Zoom, participants can ask questions through the Zoom chat and through the Q&A feature. It's important you have separate people assigned to answering these questions. It's also recommended that these people get a good introduction in the subject matter and have relevant GitLab handbook URLs ready. They should also feel empowered to relay the question asked to the host and panelist. Note that people in this role need to be panelists within Zoom or they will not have the feature to reply in the Q&A section.

Participants

These are the people that signed up to be part of the webinar but are not any of the above roles. They will be able to ask questions but not answer them.

Starting the webinar

Ensure all non-participants join 5 minutes before the start of the webinar and only start livestreaming once everyone has joined.

You must additionally start the livestream to YouTube (an additional step), with instructions detailed on [Zoom's support page](#). In the event that YouTube livestreaming refuses to begin, it's likely that a parallel livestream is happening already on GitLab Unfiltered. If this happens, proceed with the Zoom webinar livestream and upload the recording to GitLab Unfiltered per the instructions below.

Clarify in the introduction how you want participants to submit questions, ideally through Zoom chat or the Q&A function, not by opening up Google Doc access to those outside of GitLab.

When the webinar is over

When the webinar is finished, we need to make sure the video is published correctly on our GitLab Unfiltered channel. If we were the organizers, it will be on YouTube already as we livestreamed it. If not, upload the video to our GitLab Unfiltered channel. In both cases, the

following checklist need to be executed:

- Add to the proper GitLab Unfiltered playlist.
- Copy over the webinar description into YouTube. Don't leave the show notes/description blank.
- Add relevant handbook links discussed in the show to the description box as well.
- Add relevant tags within the video editor window in YouTube.
- Record the 1) number of registrations in the webinar; 2) retrieve a complete email list of the registrants; and 3) record the number of live viewers.
- Copy the final URL to the recorded and uploaded video for future async viewing.
- Document each of the above elements in the parent issue of the webinar. If an issue was not created for the webinar, share this information in the content Slack channel, tagging the DRI of the webinar content, and request that they port the information into an issue for archive purposes.

Webinars with the CEO

When there's a webinar with the CEO, it is expected that the CEO Shadows execute the steps outlined in the when the webinar is over paragraph.

SECTION: company/_index.md

SECTION: company/amas.md

An AMA (Ask Me Anything) is a session for team members to ask a specific individual or group of individuals questions either generally or on a specific topic.

Examples include a specific executive member, a particular project, quarterly report follow-up, and regarding a significant policy change at GitLab.

Reoccurring AMAs & DRI

While most AMAs only occur once or as requested, some AMAs are scheduled regularly.

AMAs	DRI	AMA Frequency	Alternate Hosts	Scheduling DRI
-----	---	-----	-----	-----
AMA with the CEO	EBA to CEO	Monthly	N/A	EBA to CEO

Request an AMA

- The EBA Team manages the GitLab Team Meetings calendar and their events.
- The EBA Team moderate Group Conversations and AMAs.
- As part of designated Bring Your Family and Friends to Work events, some AMAs will be open to family members (including kids) and friends. These AMAs will be a subset of AMAs that do not contain sensitive data (sensitive data includes: information we usually don't share publicly).

These events will be publicized ahead of time through whats-happening-at-gitlab. The calendar invite for these AMAs will specify that they are "open to family and friends." To arrange this, reach out to your EBA team member and ask them to update the calendar invite to show "open to family and friends". In the event your EBA is OOO, please reach out in slack to '@exec-admins' to add it.

We suggest each person attend via their own device to avoid hybrid meetings. We encourage you to follow up with your guest after to debrief and share call impressions. For this it might be good to be in the same room but only if you are sure not to get echo's.

Steps to Request an AMA

1. To request an AMA be put on the GitLab team meetings calendar, the requestor should find a date and time on the GitLab Team Meetings calendar that works for the AMA host.

1. The requestor will slack the EBA for their department in the eba-team Slack Channel and provide the following information:

- Title of AMA
- Public or Private Livestream
- Date & Time (YYYY-MM-DD PST)
- Host
- Moderator
- Agenda Link
- Attendees (specify if calendar invitations go to specific teams or to gitlab-team-members@gitlab.com)

- Confirm if this call is "open to friends and family"

1. The EBA will create the event in the EBA Zoom account and add it to the GitLab team meetings calendar.

- The EBA will add the AMA document link in the description and invite the specified attendees to the meeting.

- In order to limit traffic in the document during the call, the link for the AMA document in the meeting invitation should contain "/preview" at the end of the address to direct attendees to the preview version, with instructions in the body of the document directing those who have questions to editable version.

- The EBA will add Alternate Hosts if applicable.

Defining Terms

Host

The Host of a Zoom call is the person leading the conversation, usually the DRI, subject matter expert, and overseer of any slides created for a call (another term for the role is Presenter).

Questions will generally be directed to the Host, and they will usually answer them unless they feel that another team member has more information or expertise to offer. The Host/Presenter makes sure that questions are asked in the order they are listed in the agenda document.

The "Host" term can be confusing as Zoom has a specific definition for Host pertaining mainly to a permission level, which in practice GitLab does not assign to the term. More information on Zoom's definition of "host" is explained in the Moderator section below.

Moderator

The Moderator of a Zoom call is the person that has Zoom's Host level permission. Host level permission in Zoom permits streaming a call to YouTube, starting or ending a recording and giving co-hosting permissions to others.

The Moderator of a Zoom call is the person who is in charge of starting the call i.e. initiating the streaming to YouTube; updating the stream from public to private if a sensitive topic is mentioned, and keeping the meeting running efficiently and on time so that it does not go over the Quick Meeting time frame.

For Attendees

Attendance is optional - if you are unable to attend an AMA at its scheduled time, don't let that hold you back!

1. Please enter your questions or comments on the linked Google Doc. Preface your question with your full name (first and last name) because there might be other people with your first name on the call and it's helpful to newcomers if they are distinguished. Remember First Post is a Badge of Honor.

1. Keep in mind that an AMA may be live streamed and shared publicly and that it's okay to opt out of using your name due to safety and privacy concerns.

1. Please do not include customer names in your questions/comments.

1. Be ready to ask your question out loud as it comes up in the queue.

1. When speaking on the call, please say your name first, to help others know who is speaking.

1. Please don't use the Zoom chat to add information but add them to the doc so people reading the agenda after the call can also benefit.

1. Not everything has to be a question. If you have a comment, bias to putting it into the Google Doc so that those who weren't able to attend the meeting live can see what you had to say (and any responses that arose from it).

1. Thanking and recognizing people is very important.

1. It's okay to add a question to the end of the queue in the Google Doc as the conversation is taking place.

1. You can contribute by taking notes to transcribe the answers during the conversation.

Thanks!

1. Make sure there are at least 10 empty items in the list (that just contain a space) for people to add new questions.

For Moderators

The EBA team is responsible for moderating the following calls on a rotational basis:

- AMAs (If requested with sufficient notice as per the instructions in the request an AMA section).

The teams will assist with moderating calls where the audience is applicable to all GitLab team members. In the event that a separate meeting needs to be scheduled on the team calendar with only a specified invitee list, the host or the EBA for the host's organization will be responsible for moderating the call.

Recording or commencement of live stream should not be started without alignment with the host. Moderator should check with host for readiness at the scheduled start time before hitting record.

SECTION: company/being-a-public-company.md

GitLab as a Public Company

In 2017, GitLab established aspirational milestones for a public offering, achieving \$1B of annualized recurring revenue, and positive operating cash flow in order to align our efforts and investments to common goals. GitLab began trading on the Nasdaq Global Select Market on October 14, 2021 under the ticker symbol "GTLB."

We continue to believe that being a public company is an integral part of realizing our mission. As a public company, GitLab may benefit from enhanced brand awareness, access to capital, shareholder liquidity, autonomy, and transparency.

Public Company Readiness

To achieve fair value with limited relative volatility as a publicly traded company, we are focused on the following:

1. Ability to meet the quarter close schedule outlined on the Investor Relations page
1. Consistent execution against key operating metrics and initiatives
1. Demonstrate a reliable trajectory of revenue growth to operating cash flow that aligns to our target operating model and hypergrowth objectives
1. Assessing the maturity of our model in conjunction with equity market volatility to determine an appropriate time for a public offering
1. Building out a fulsome compliance program which includes: securities law trainings, communications policies, handbook adjustments, required policies such as insider / trading window
1. Maintaining a high degree of transparency that we believe increases contributions and makes collaboration easier. This is a core value and may result in higher than expected volatility.

A successful public offering is a significant milestone, but it is not GitLab's mission. Like graduating from high school, a great day but it shouldn't be the biggest thing you achieve in life.

Market Capitalization

Market capitalization (stock price x shares outstanding) will be the result of a combination of factors most directly associated with the following areas:

1. Size of total addressable market
1. Consistency of execution
1. Competitive position
1. Clarity of value proposition
1. Perception of management team

As GitLab team members, delivering on our annual plan and long-term strategy are the most productive ways to contribute to the company achieving full, fair value with limited relative volatility. At a departmental level, we have key performance indicators aligned to our plan and performance to empower "everyone to contribute" to GitLab's long term success and public market valuation.

Short Term Focus Can Be A Distraction

A finer point on valuation: In the long run, our underlying business performance will be the fundamental driver of GitLab's stock price. Workplace conversations on the stock price can be a distraction; we should instead shift discussions to our KPIs and focus on growing the change in annual recurring revenue (ARR).

Long-term initiatives may take years to show profitable results, and in the short term they can create drag. Teams that become overly focused on stock price will tend to avoid longer-term investments, preferring to boost revenue and profit in the short term. This is why it's important that incentives are in place to grow the company over the long term.

The father of value investing, Benjamin Graham, explained this concept by saying, "In the short run, the market is like a voting machine, tallying up which firms are popular and unpopular. But in the long run, the market is like a weighing machine, assessing the substance of a company."

Long Term Targets Underpin Efficient, Durable Growth

Our financial planning process includes setting a division's spend based on revenue growth as we move towards our long term profitability target. We view these spending objectives (as a percent of revenue) as a measure of our efficient use of capital. These objectives are not because we aim to go public. As we capture a larger percentage of the market, growth could moderate and shift operating cash flow margin to a more significant factor in our hypergrowth target.

Two Actionable Values

Transparency and Iteration are deeply ingrained in the GitLab culture. GitLab is working to be the most transparent and iterative company in the world, and we believe this will set new standards for public companies. We continue to ask ourselves to what extent being marked as an attractive emplo